

Motorola G85 5G

Stunning design and display, but lacks performance chops

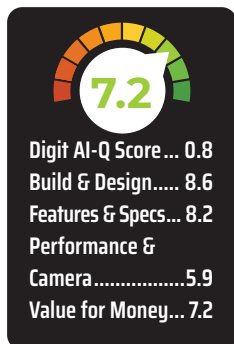
The Motorola G85 is the latest addition to Motorola's budget-range lineup, promising a blend of premium features and affordability. Starting at ₹17,999, it seeks to stand out in a crowded market, competing with budget contenders like the CMF Phone 1 (review), Realme P1 (review), and OnePlus Nord CE4 Lite (review). With highlights including a curved pOLED display, a 50MP camera, and stereo speakers, the G85 promises a blend of stylish design and high-end features that are uncommon in this price range. But does it truly stand out amid the growing array of value-for-money smartphones? Let's explore the details to find out.



BUILD AND DESIGN

The Motorola G85 punches way above its weight class in terms of design. It is hard to believe that this phone costs merely ₹17,999, given its slender look, relatively slim bezels, and curved body. It stands out with its premium design, featuring a plastic frame and a vegan leather back. In my opinion, the only phone that could compete with the Motorola G85 in terms of looks under ₹20,000 is the CMF Phone 1. The Motorola G85 has a more elegant look while the CMF Phone 1 looks industrial and quirky.

Despite its budget-friendly price, the phone feels sturdy and decently well-built. The vegan leather back not only adds a touch of elegance but also provides a good grip, making it comfortable to hold. The phone is available in three colour variants – Olive Green, Urban Grey, and Cobalt Blue. I got the Olive Green variant for review, and



while it looks stunning, the vegan leather material feels way cheaper than what's used on the Edge 50 series.

At just 7.6 mm thick and weighing 173 grams, the G85 is impressively lightweight, especially considering its massive 5,000 mAh battery. The curved contours of the phone make it extremely comfortable to hold even over longer periods. The IP52 rating leaves something to be desired since competitors like the Realme P1 offer a higher IP54 rating, which is exponentially better in cities like Mumbai that experience heavy rainfall.

DISPLAY

One of the standout features of the Motorola G85 is its 6.67-inch pOLED curved display with a 120Hz refresh rate. The display is vibrant and bright, with a peak brightness of 1600 nits,

making it easy to use even under direct sunlight. However, as per my testing, the Motorola G85 doesn't reach its claimed peak brightness numbers. The phone touched 1,002 nits under direct sunlight on High Brightness Mode, which is still good enough for outdoor legibility.

One thing that's missing is HDR support. The phone does not support HDR content on OTT apps. However, given the inexpensive price tag, it can be overlooked as there is Widevine L1 support allowing support for HD content. HD content looks good on OTT platforms, and the Dolby Atmos-enabled stereo speakers add to the immersive experience.

The display is protected by Corning Gorilla Glass 5, which adds a layer of durability against scratches and minor drops. The 120Hz refresh rate ensures smooth scrolling and a more responsive touch experience, which is particularly noticeable when navigating through apps.

PERFORMANCE AND UI

Under the hood, the Motorola G85 is powered by the Snapdragon 6s Gen 3 chipset, paired with up to 12GB of RAM and 256GB of internal storage. The Snapdragon 6s Gen 3 is essentially a rebranded Snapdragon 695, the same chipset that powered its predecessor, the Motorola G84. So, there's no significant upgrade in performance. Nevertheless, this chipset handles everyday tasks such as browsing, social media, and light gaming smoothly.

However, it may struggle with more demanding applications and heavy multitasking. It lags behind more powerful competitors like the Realme P1 and CMF Phone 1, both of which are priced lower than the Motorola G85. As a result, the value proposition for those who prioritise performance diminishes significantly.

The performance disparity between the Motorola G85 and its competitors is evident in its benchmark results. The phone scores lower on AnTuTu, Geek-Bench, and PCMark Work compared